

Diploma in

PHOTOSHOP



SUMMARY NOTES

Text & Shape Layers
Lessons 17 & 18

WHETHER YOU WANT TO TURN YOUR IMAGE INTO A SIMPLE POSTCARD OR CREATE AN ELABORATE ADVERTISEMENT, WORKING WITH TEXT IN PHOTOSHOP IS AN ESSENTIAL SKILL TO MASTER. WE WILL LOOK AT HOW TO EFFECTIVELY FORMAT TEXT AND DISCUSS CONCEPTS SUCH AS ALIGNMENT, JUSTIFICATION, TRACKING, KERNING, AND LEADING.

1.01	Shape Tool
1.02	Text Tool
1.03	Text & Shape Layers
1.04	Layer FX

Text & Shape Layers

SHAPE TOOL

“To constrain a rectangle or rounded rectangle to a square, to constrain an ellipse to a circle, or to constrain the line angle to a multiple of 45 degrees, hold down Shift.”

We have a range of options when using The Shape Tool:

1. **Rectangle Shape Tool**
2. **Rounded Rectangle Shape Tool**
3. **Elliptical Shape Tool**
4. **Polygonal Shape Tool**
5. **Line Tool**
6. **Custom Shape Tool**

Note: Custom shapes are defaulted to a small selection in Photoshop, to see all available shapes use the cog wheel and load all.

To Draw a shape:

1. **Select a shape tool.**
2. **Make sure Shape is chosen from the menu in the options bar.**
3. **To choose the colour of the shape, click the colour swatch in the options bar, and then choose a colour from the Colour Picker.**
4. **Drag in your image to draw a shape**

Notes: To constrain a rectangle or rounded rectangle to a square, to constrain an ellipse to a circle, or to constrain the line angle to a multiple of 45 degrees, hold down Shift.

To draw from the centre out, position the pointer where you want the centre of the shape to be, press Alt/Option, and then drag diagonally to any corner or edge until the shape is the desired size.

When using the shape tool you will have specific properties and options to use:

Options: draw as Shape, Path or Pixels

Fill: Solid Colour, Gradient Pattern, Colour Picker or No Fill (No Fill is shown as a red stroke through the box)

Stroke: Solid Colour, Gradient Pattern, Colour Picker or No Fill (No Fill is shown as a red stroke through the box)

Stroke Size: Slider to change the pixel size so the stroke

Stroke Type: Optional strokes to choose

Shape Parameters/Width & Height: pixel size of the image, can be adjusted manually

Alignment: Shape Align

Placement: Shape placement behind or in front

Custom Shape: only available on custom shape tool

Multiple Shape Options

- **New Layer:** Will create each shape you draw as a new layer.
- **Combine Shapes:** Will draw multiple shapes on the same layer
- **Subtract Front Shape:** Will remove the shape on top from the shape below
- **Intersect Shape Area:** Will provide a shape based on the intersection of two combined shapes
- **Exclude Overlapping Areas:** Will remove the intersecting section of the overlapping shapes.

TEXT TOOL

We have a range of options when using The Shape Tool:

- **Horizontal TypeTool**
- **Vertical TypeTool**
- **Horizontal TypeMaskTool**
- **Vertical TypeMaskTool**

Note: to type on a path you must hover over the path until the text icon changes.

Font: Choose the font you wish to use.

Font-Family: Choose the weight or style of the font. Eg Bold, Italic

TextSize: changes the Pixel size or point size of the chosen font.

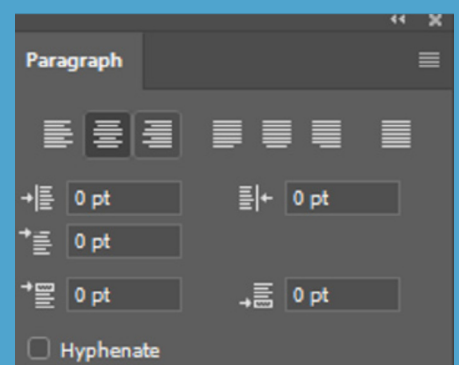
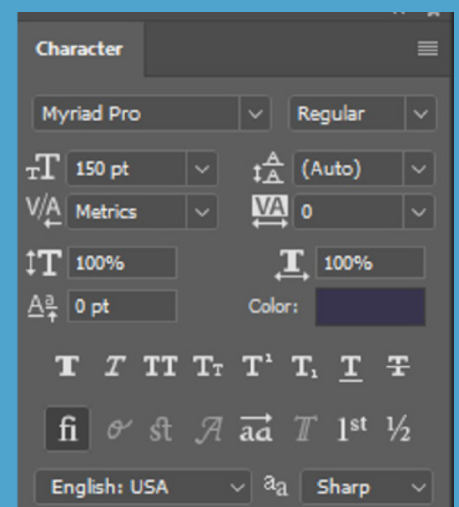
Anti-Aliasing: produces smooth-edged type by partially filling the edge pixels

- **None** Applies no anti-aliasing
- **Sharp** Type appears at its sharpest
- **Crisp** Type appears somewhat sharp
- **Strong** Type appears heavier
- **Smooth** Type appears smoother

ParagraphStyles: choose between Left aligned, right aligned or centre aligned

TextColour: Change the colour of the chosen font from the colour picker

CharacterIcon: Opens the Character Panel (not present on all Photoshop versions)



Note: It is also possible to force a font to have a Faux Bold, Faux Italic, All Caps, Small Caps, Superscript, Subscript, Underline, and Strikethrough.

TEXT & SHAPE LAYERS

Typeface V Fonts

Typeface



Franklin Gothic Book
Franklin Gothic Medium
Franklin Gothic Demi
Franklin Gothic Heavy
Franklin Gothic Medium Condensed
Franklin Gothic Demi Condensed

Font



Franklin Gothic Book

A typeface is a family of fonts (such as the Franklin Gothic Typeface here, Helvetica Regular, Helvetica Italic, Helvetica Bold, Helvetica Black, etc. would be another.) But a font is one weight or style within a typeface family (such as Franklin Gothic Book).

Text Type v Display Type

Text Type—usually between 8 – 10 points, is designed to be used in large quantities at small sizes, for example most of newspaper and magazine type is Text Type. It has to be easy to read. Smooth reading is the goal and should seem as effortless as possible when we are reading. Again good Text & Shape Layers should nearly go unnoticed. Text Types share some common characteristics to aid the clarity and smooth readability.

- Open Spaces
- Tall Body Type in comparison to the Capitals
- Rhythmic Repetitive Shapes
- Medium Weight

Display Type—is usually 14 point or larger and is used in small quantities for emphasis and effect. Display Type is designed to be noticed. There is a vast number available for every possible use from Handwriting to Space Age! Text Type can function as Display Type, but not the other way around.

Display Type is like the icing on your cake when it comes to design.



There are many different classifications and sub-classification of typefaces, but the most common two types you will hear of are Serif & Sans-serif

Serif—these typefaces are the more traditional ones. They are distinguished by a short line or finishing stroke on the end of character strokes and stems. Serifs are evident in both capital and lowercase letters. The angles of the Serifs can vary. Their thickness and width can also vary. These may be small details but this all matters when it is set in a size suitable for reading.

SansSerif—as the name suggests, these are distinguished by their lack of any Serifs. They only became popular in the nineteenth century and are considered modern as a result. They have no Feet. By their meaning “Sans” means without in French.

SlabSerif—A Sub-Category of Serif are what are called Slab Serifs, and they are exactly what they sound like. The difference is their Horizontal strokes are the same width as their Vertical strokes.

Script—Based on handwritten letters. Mostly or partly attached. Can be formal or informal (handwritten, brush). Can be tricky to use because of large swashes.

Monospace—The letters each measure equidistant horizontally. They were first created for typewriters, where each letter's spacing had to be identical.

Blackletter/Fraktur—Look fractured or broken because each letter is made up of individual strokes. Tend to be heavy in appearance, hence the name! Often called **Old English**. Small spaces within and between letters, and tight spacing between the lines. Overall colour on the page is heavy or black.

Display—Display fonts have a huge variety, these are the fonts you should use when you want to make an impact. Good for capturing user's attention. These should not be used for body copy as they generally need to be a large size for readability.

Serif

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ - abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
The quick brown Fox jumped over the lazy Dog

Sans Serif

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ - abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
The quick brown Fox jumped over the lazy Dog

Slab Serif

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ - abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
The quick brown Fox jumped over the lazy Dog

Script

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ - abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
The quick brown Fox jumped over the lazy Dog

Blackletter/ Fraktur

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ - abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
The quick brown Fox jumped over the lazy Dog

Display

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ - ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
THE QUICK BROWN FOX JUMPED OVER THE LAZY DOG



Serifs**OLDSTYLE**(15th–18th Century) – *Calson, Sabon, Bembo, Garamond*

- Low contrast between thick and thin strokes. Thick Bracketed Serifs. Long ascenders and descenders, the parts of the letters that extend above and below the body height.

TRANSITIONAL(bridge between Old-style & Modern, mid-18th century due to advances in printing and font making technology) – *Baskerville, Bell, Georgia*

- Sharper flatter Serifs. Tighter Bracketed Curve. Stress in curved letters is more vertical (an example would be the letter O, the stress axis is an imaginary line connecting the thinnest parts). Higher contrast between thick and thin strokes

MODERN(late 18th century) – *Didot, Modern No. 20, New Caledonia*

- Extreme contrast between thick and thin strokes. Ultra-thin, un-bracketed serifs.

SLABSERIF – *Rockwell, Memphis, Serifa*

- Used for advertising and signage because of their weight and strong presence. Serifs are generally un-bracketed or square. Main characteristic is lack of contrast between strokes. (Thicks and Thins are almost, if not equal weight.)

Bracketed | Unbracketed

- Two more categories of Serifs are Bracketed and Un-bracketed. Bracketed have a curved angle. Un-bracketed have a sharp 90° angle.

Sans-Serif**Grotesque/Gothic** – *NewsGothic, Helvetica, Univers, Verdana*

- Slight variations in stroke width. Letters are wide. Rounded letters can be squared off. They are based off actual scripture from the Gothic period in history.

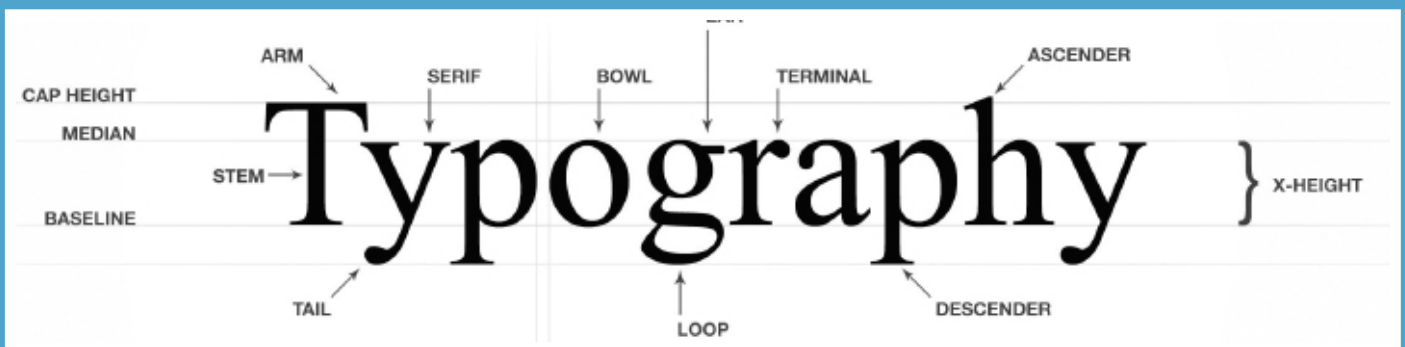
Humanist – *GillSans, Myriad, Optima, Frutiger*

- Humanist sans come from the root and attitude of humanist serif fonts. These typefaces are calligraphic in structure, often with higher stroke contrast than other sans serifs.

Geometric – *Futura, Avant-Garde, Kabel, Century Gothic*

- Based on geometric forms of circle, square and triangle. Reflect the modernist movement of the 20th century.

The different letterforms within a typeface share a few common characteristics. These characteristics can be important in determining whether two (or more) typefaces work well together. Here are the most basic parts of a typeface: The image shows different guidelines that are generally present in a typeface.



The **BASELINE** is the invisible line that all the characters sit on. Rounded letters sometimes sit just a tiny bit under the baseline, and descenders always drop below this line. A given typeface will have a consistent baseline.

The **MEDIAN** is the height of most of the lowercase characters within a typeface, and is generally based on the lowercase "x" if there are varying heights among the lowercase characters. This is also where the term "x-height" comes from.

The **CAP HEIGHT** is the distance between the baseline and the top of uppercase letters like "T".

Type is measured in Points. In every Inch there are 6 units called Picas. In every Pica there are 12 Points. So doing the math, there are 72 points in an Inch. The Point size is the height of the Body of the piece of type. The Body Height depends on the tallest Ascender and the lowest Descender in the font. Within that the X-height can vary, which is why some typefaces that are the same point size, can look quite different.

Kerning is the adjustment of the spaces between two specific letters.

It is different from Tracking which is the adjustment of the spaces between a group of letters. The goal of Kerning is to create a consistent rhythm of space between characters which helps readability. At text sizes the Kerning has already been set by the type designer, but at larger sizes the space between the letters may need manual Kerning. By kerning our letters, we want the eye to see them as evenly spaced in a way that is optically correct. It's about creating what looks right, not necessarily, what's mechanically correct. Imagine that the spaces between letters are containers of water. You want every space between two letters to look as if it holds the same amount of water.

Tracking is the spacing of a group of characters. Tracking relates to the spacing of all characters and is applied evenly.

Leading describes the vertical space between each line of type. It's called this because strips of lead were originally used to separate lines of type in the days of metal typesetting. For legible body text that's comfortable to read, a general rule is that your leading value should be greater than the font size; anywhere from 1.25 to 1.5 times. You can measure leading by obtaining the distance between two baselines.

Measure refers to the length of lines of text in a paragraph or column. Measure is an important thing to get right in Text & Shape Layers as it can be crucial to the readability of the text. If the measure is too wide the text may be difficult to read as the eye has to move a lot more after each line is read. If it is too narrow it can also be tiring on the eye to read, as the eye is constantly moving back and forth. A narrow measure will also lead to a lot of hyphenation. The most useful way to measure line length is by average characters per line. Measuring in inches or centimetres is less useful because the point size of the font affects the number of characters per inch. Average characters per line works independently of point size.

Aim for an average line length of 45–90 characters, including spaces.

Contrast is one of the most important concepts to understand when it comes to combining typefaces. Without proper contrast, typefaces tend to clash, creating a random, scattered look to your designs.

Factors for Combining Type

Contrast or differentiation (body text plus headline text). If Body Text is Serif, then for contrast look for something like a Sans Serif for headlines. Most projects don't need more than two Typefaces.

When combining Typefaces consider their basic characteristics:

- Similar Historical Period with different features may work well
- Typefaces from the same designer.
- Maybe choose very opposite Typefaces, one traditional and sober, the other, friendly and warm.
- Typefaces with similar Body Height can work well as long as their styles are contrasting.

A common mistake is combining Typefaces that are too individual, they have strong stylistic details so they conflict. If you find it necessary to add a third typeface, Slab Serifs can work well. Can be good to separate content and make it stand out from the other text elements.

Think of choosing types as getting dressed or putting an outfit together. Too many complex patterns will clash, they should complement each other, so one simple piece and one complex piece will work a lot better.

There are no hard rules but let good taste be your guide.

LAYER STYLES

You can enhance a layer by adding a shadow, stroke, satin sheen, or other special effect from a collection of automated and editable layer styles. These styles are easy to apply, and they link directly to the layer you specify. Like layers, layer styles can be hidden by clicking eye icons in the Layers panel. Layer styles are non-destructive, so you can edit or remove them at any time. You can apply a copy of a layer style to a different layer by dragging the effect onto the destination layer. You can apply a layer style to a layer by double-clicking the layer, going to “Layer-Layer Style” in the Main

Menu, or clicking the FX icon in the layers panel.

DropShadow-Addsa shadow that falls behind the contents on the layer.

InnerShadow-Addsa shadowthat falls just inside the edges of the layer’s content, giving the layer a recessed appearance.

OuterGlowand **InnerGlow**-Add glows that emanate from the outside or inside edges of the layer’s content.

Beveland **Emboss**-Add various combinations of highlights and shadows to a layer.

Satin-Applies interior shading that creates a satiny finish.

Color, Gradient, and **PatternOverlay** - Fills the layer’s content with a color, gradient, or pattern.

Stroke-Outlines the object on the current layer using color, a gradient, or a pattern. It is particularly useful on hard-edged shapes such as type.





THANK YOU